Deliberation Transcripts: Foreign PMET Salary Thresholds and Local Career Progression

Item ID: ITEM_02 | **Sessions:** 24 Trials (4 Dyads × 5 Trials) | **Total Dialogue Turns:** 96 turns | **Source:** item02_foreign_talent_transcript.json

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D1: Technocrat vs Ideologue

Dynamic: Ideological Friction | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

Singapore must retain its attractiveness as a global hub while ensuring that the domestic PMET pipeline is not eroded; therefore, any salary threshold for foreign hires should be calibrated to reflect genuine skill gaps and linked to measurable knowledge■transfer outcomes. I propose a tiered threshold that rises with the seniority of the role and is coupled with mandatory on■the■job mentorship or up■skilling commitments for local staff. By aligning the cost of hiring abroad with concrete capacity■building deliverables, we can safeguard local career progression without compromising the city■state's competitive edge.

Turn 2 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I applaud the idea of tying salary thresholds to measurable knowledge■transfer, yet we must ensure that the threshold is not merely a fiscal hurdle but a genuine safeguard for our mid■career PMETs whose futures are at stake. Let us set a baseline salary floor that reflects the median local senior■PMET earnings, and require any foreign hire above that floor to commit a proportionate number of mentorship hours and a clear succession plan within the first twelve months. Moreover, a transparent audit board comprising industry veterans, unions and academia should monitor compliance, with penalties that include revoking the hiring licence if the promised up■skilling does not materialise. This way we preserve Singapore's openness to world■class talent while honouring our duty to nurture homegrown leaders.

Turn 3 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that the audit board should be multi■stakeholder and that mentorship obligations be proportional to the salary differential, but we should also incorporate a performance■based rebate: firms that demonstrably meet or exceed knowledge■transfer targets could receive a calibrated reduction in the threshold surcharge. To keep the system fiscally transparent, the rebate rates and assessment metrics would be published annually by the Ministry of Manpower in consultation with the board. This approach preserves the cost signal that protects local PMETs while rewarding companies that deliver tangible up■skilling outcomes, ensuring both openness and domestic career progression.

Turn 4 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I welcome the performance■based rebate, for it honors both fairness to our local talent and the need to stay globally competitive; however, the rebate must be contingent on a publicly audited "knowledge■transfer index" that quantifies not only mentorship hours but also concrete outcomes such as local promotions, patent filings, or curriculum contributions. Let us therefore enshrine a minimum 12■month reporting cycle, with the audit board empowered to suspend the rebate—and any associated tax relief—if the index falls short of agreed targets. By binding financial incentives to transparent, outcome■driven metrics, we protect our mid■career PMETs while still inviting the world■class expertise that fuels Singapore's growth.

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D2: Technocrat vs Populist

Dynamic: Asymmetric Vulnerability | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

The foreign PMET salary thresholds should be calibrated to attract the specific skill sets Singapore needs while ensuring that the differential does not erode the progression ladder for local PMETs. We can achieve this by tying the thresholds to measurable productivity gains and mandating a structured knowledge■transfer component for each foreign hire. A transparent, data■driven review every two years would allow us to adjust the thresholds in line with labour market outcomes. This approach balances openness with safeguards for local career development.

Turn 2 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

Look, we can't keep letting foreign PMETs swoop in on jobs just because they fetch a higher salary on paper – my sister's husband was passed over for a senior role even though he's been with the company for years. If you want to keep the hub■status, set a clear cap: any foreign hire must earn at least 30 % above the median local salary **and** the company must pledge a mentorship plan that guarantees a local employee will be promoted within two years. Let the Ministry audit those promises and fine firms that cheat, so we keep the talent flow but protect our own ladder.

Turn 3 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that a clear, enforceable framework is essential, and a salary differential tied to measurable productivity can serve that purpose while avoiding arbitrary caps. Let us set the foreign■PMET threshold at a calibrated premium—e.g., 20 % above the median local salary for comparable roles—subject to a mandatory, auditable knowledge■transfer plan that includes a documented mentorship timeline and a measurable promotion target for a local employee within two years. The Ministry of Manpower can conduct biennial reviews, adjusting the premium based on actual productivity gains and promotion outcomes, and impose graduated fines for non■compliance. This structure preserves Singapore's hub appeal, ensures tangible skill transfer, and protects the career progression of our local PMETs.

Turn 4 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I get that you want numbers and reviews, but the truth is families are watching real promotions slip away while foreign hires sit on fat paychecks. Let's fix the premium at 30 % above the local median – that's a real bite■off for companies – and make the mentorship promise concrete: a written development plan, quarterly check■ins, and a guaranteed promotion slot for a Singaporean within 18 months, otherwise the firm pays a steep fine that goes into a retraining fund. The Ministry can still do a biennial audit, but the penalty should be enough to make firms think twice before sidestepping locals. This way we keep the talent we need, but we also protect the ladder for our own people.

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D3: Ideologue vs Populist

Dynamic: Polarized Stalemate | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

We cannot afford to let the influx of high■paid foreign PMETs erode the career prospects and dignity of our own mid■career talent, yet we also must keep Singapore vibrant as a global innovation hub that benefits every Singaporean. I propose we begin by insisting on transparent salary bands and mandatory knowledge■transfer quotas for companies that hire above the local threshold, so that foreign expertise becomes a catalyst rather than a competitor. Let us explore how such safeguards can be paired with targeted incentives for firms that invest in upskilling our home■grown PMETs, ensuring both openness and equity.

Turn 2 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I hear you, but we can't keep watching our mates get pushed out of senior roles while big firms bring in foreigners on sky■high packages and then claim it's for "knowledge transfer". If a company wants to hire a foreign PMET above the local salary threshold, they should first prove they've filled the same role with a Singaporean at a comparable level, or else pay a hefty levy that goes straight into a fund for local upskilling. Only when they can show a clear, measurable mentorship plan – like a 1■to■1 trainee for every foreign hire for at least two years – should the extra salary be allowed. That way we keep the talent pipeline open for the world, but not at the expense of our own people's career ladders.

Turn 3 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I agree that any foreign hiring above the threshold must be tethered to genuine opportunities for Singapore■born PMETs, so I would add a tiered levy that escalates if a firm fails to meet a concrete Singaporean■candidate■first test within a defined recruitment window. In return, firms that demonstrably mentor a local colleague—documented through a formal 1■to■1 plan and periodic progress reviews—should receive a rebate on that levy, encouraging authentic knowledge transfer rather than token gestures. We can also mandate transparent salary bands publicly posted on company portals, ensuring that both employers and workers can verify that local talent is not being sidelined. Together, these measures protect career progression while preserving the openness that keeps Singapore attractive to global expertise.

Turn 4 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I like the idea of a clear “Singapore■first” test and a levy that goes straight into a skills fund, but we must make sure the fund actually reaches the PMETs on the ground – maybe tie it to subsidies for short■course vouchers that our mates can use right away. If a firm can prove they’ve hired a Singaporean first, the levy should be waived, not just reduced, so there’s a real incentive to look locally before looking abroad. And the mentorship plan must be audited by an independent body, with penalties if the foreign hire ends up doing the same job without any knowledge transfer, otherwise companies will just game the paperwork.

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D4: Ideologue vs Everyman

Dynamic: Rhetorical Dominance | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

Singapore’s future must be built on the promise that every local PMET can see a clear, equitable path to senior leadership, not be eclipsed by a flood of overseas hires merely because they command higher salaries. We can welcome global talent, but only if firms commit to robust knowledge■transfer programmes, mentorship quotas and transparent salary bands that protect our homegrown mid■career workers from wage suppression. Let us start by proposing a jointly■governed framework that ties foreign■talent permits to measurable up■skilling outcomes for Singaporeans, ensuring growth does not come at the expense of our own talent pipeline.

Turn 2 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I hear your concern that our local PMETs need a clear route to senior roles, and I agree that any influx of overseas talent should help—not hinder—our own career progression. Perhaps we could set a modest salary■threshold for foreign hires, coupled with a requirement that companies submit an annual “up■skilling plan” showing how they will mentor Singapore■born staff and open a certain number of leadership spots to them over time. A joint committee of industry, unions and the Ministry could monitor these commitments and adjust the thresholds if we see genuine knowledge transfer. This way we keep Singapore attractive to global talent while safeguarding the growth prospects of our homegrown mid■career workers.

Turn 3 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I concur that a transparent salary■threshold tied to concrete up■skilling commitments can bridge openness and protection, provided the threshold is indexed to the median local senior■PMET wage rather than an arbitrary figure, so firms cannot simply bypass it with inflated offers. Let us embed a legally■binding mentorship quota—say 30 percent of senior■level projects must include a Singapore■born co■lead—and require annual public reporting audited by an independent tripartite board. This board should have the power to suspend or revoke foreign■talent permits if measurable knowledge■transfer targets are missed, ensuring that global talent truly augments—not displaces—our homegrown pipeline.

Turn 4 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think anchoring the salary threshold to the median senior■PMET wage is a sensible way to keep it fair, and a 30 percent mentorship quota could give our local talent real exposure to senior projects. To make it workable, perhaps we could start with a pilot period of two years, during which companies report progress and the tripartite board offers guidance rather than immediate penalties, allowing firms to adjust their plans without disruption. If the pilot shows clear knowledge■transfer results, we can then formalise the quota and introduce graduated sanctions for firms that consistently fall short.

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D5: Populist vs Everyman

Dynamic: Grassroots Realignment | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I’ve seen my brother get passed over for a senior role just because a foreign grad came in on a higher salary, and it feels like our own hard■earned experience is being sold cheap. We need a clear rule that companies can only hire overseas PMETs above a certain pay level, while guaranteeing that local mid■career workers get a guaranteed path to promotion and salary growth. Let’s start by agreeing on a transparent salary threshold tied to real cost■of■living numbers, and a mandatory knowledge■transfer plan that gives Singaporeans a real shot at leadership. If we can lock in those two safeguards, we can keep the talent pipeline open without trampling on our own people.

Turn 2 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I understand why you feel frustrated when you see a colleague being overlooked, and I agree that Singaporeans should have clear, fair chances to move up. Perhaps we could set a transparent salary■threshold that triggers a “local talent first” review, while also requiring firms hiring foreign PMETs to submit a concrete mentorship and knowledge■transfer plan with measurable milestones. If the company can show that local staff are being prepared for senior roles within a reasonable timeframe, the higher■paid foreign hire could be approved. This way we keep our doors open to valuable global expertise but also protect and develop our own mid■career workforce.

Turn 3 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I like the idea of a “local talent first” check, but it must be a hard stop – if the company can’t prove they’ll promote a Singaporean within 12 months, the foreign hire gets blocked outright. The mentorship plan should be audited by a neutral body and linked to actual salary bumps for the locals involved, not just paperwork. Let’s also cap the foreign■PMET salary at, say, 1.5 times the median local mid■career pay, so we don’t end up paying sky■high fees that push our own workers down the ladder.

Turn 4 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I see the need for a firm safeguard, so perhaps we could set the salary cap at 1.5 times the median mid■career pay, but allow an exception if the company can demonstrate a genuine skills gap that cannot be filled locally. The “local talent first” review could require a concrete promotion pathway with a 12■month target, and the mentorship plan could be overseen by an independent board that ties progress to incremental salary increments for the Singaporean participants. If the foreign hire meets both the salary ceiling and the verified development plan, the approval would proceed; otherwise, the company would need to revisit its recruitment strategy or invest further in upskilling locals. This way we keep the talent pipeline open while ensuring our own workers are not left behind.

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D6: Populist vs Technocrat

Dynamic: Anti-Elitist Pushback | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I’m fed up seeing fresh overseas talent swoop in for mid■level jobs while our own PMETs are stuck with stagnant wages and no clear path to senior roles. The government should keep the doors open for global expertise, but only if they set a real salary floor for locals and force companies to mentor and promote Singapore■born talent. Let’s work out a concrete cap■and■share plan that protects our families’ income while still letting firms bring in the specialised skills we need.

Turn 2 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I acknowledge that mid■career PMETs need clearer progression and that wage compression can erode morale, but imposing a blanket salary floor may discourage firms from locating high■value functions that rely on global talent. A workable approach could be to introduce a tiered “local talent uplift” incentive: companies that meet defined mentorship and promotion targets for Singapore■born staff receive tax rebates, while those that rely heavily on overseas hires must demonstrate comparable up■skilling investments. This aligns fiscal prudence with the goal of knowledge transfer without distorting market wages, and it gives firms flexibility to recruit where genuine skill gaps exist.

Turn 3 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I hear you, but tax rebates won’t help my wife who’s stuck on a flat salary while a foreigner walks in with the same job and gets a higher package. Let’s make a clear salary floor for Singapore■born PMETs and tie any rebate to actual promotion numbers, not just mentorship hours. If a firm wants to hire overseas, they must fund a guaranteed up■skilling grant that pays for our people to move into senior roles within a set timeframe. That way the incentive is real, not just paperwork, and companies still get the talent they need without trampling our families.

Turn 4 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that any floor must be tied to demonstrable outcomes, so we could set a modest baseline wage that triggers a “promotion■performance” rebate only when a firm records a net increase in senior■level Singapore■born staff within, say, three years. Companies wishing to exceed that baseline with overseas hires would then be required to fund a matching up■skilling grant that is disbursed upon each verified promotion of a local employee. By linking the rebate and the grant to concrete promotion data rather than hours of mentorship, we preserve fiscal discipline while ensuring the policy delivers tangible career progression for our PMETs.

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D7: Everyman vs Technocrat

Dynamic: Pragmatic Grounding | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think it's important that Singapore remains an attractive place for global talent, because that drives growth and creates new opportunities for all of us, but we also need to make sure our local mid■career PMETs don't feel left behind or stuck in stagnant roles. Perhaps we could look at a flexible salary threshold that allows firms to hire abroad when they truly need niche skills, while encouraging them to invest in up■skilling programmes and clear career pathways for Singapore■born employees. By setting transparent criteria and offering incentives for companies that mentor and promote local staff, we can keep the economy vibrant and still protect the prospects of our own workers.

Turn 2 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that a transparent, data■driven salary threshold is essential, but it should be anchored to measurable skill shortages rather than a blanket figure, so firms only import talent when domestic supply is demonstrably insufficient. We can complement that with a mandatory "local talent development quota" – for every foreign hire above the threshold, the employer must commit a proportionate amount of funding to certified up■skilling programmes and a mentorship plan for Singapore■born PMETs. A graduated tax rebate for companies that achieve defined localisation milestones would further incentivise career progression without distorting wage structures. This framework preserves openness for critical expertise while ensuring measurable knowledge transfer and clear pathways for our mid■career workforce.

Turn 3 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I agree that tying any salary threshold to genuine skill gaps makes sense, and I like the idea of a clear quota linked to up■skilling funds and mentorship. Perhaps we could set a modest "local talent credit" that companies earn for every Singapore■born PMET they promote into a senior role, which can offset part of the threshold requirement. That way firms still have flexibility to bring in needed expertise, while we see tangible progress in career pathways for our mid■career workers.

Turn 4 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I concur that a "local talent credit" can serve as a concrete offset, provided the credit is calibrated to the actual proportion of Singapore■born PMETs promoted into senior roles verified by an independent registry. To keep the threshold meaningful, the salary floor should be indexed to sector■specific median wages and adjusted quarterly using labour market data, so firms cannot bypass it by marginally inflating salaries. Finally, we should tie the up■skilling fund contribution to measurable skill■transfer outcomes—such as certifications earned or on■the■job competencies demonstrated—so the programme delivers genuine capacity building rather than a compliance checkbox.

Trial 1 of 6 | Dyad D8: Everyman vs Ideologue

Dynamic: Moral Grounding | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I see both the need to keep Singapore attractive to global talent and the genuine concerns of our local mid■career PMETs who feel their career paths are getting crowded. Perhaps we can start by looking at ways to ensure that foreign hires complement rather than replace local expertise, such as clear skill■gap criteria and mandatory knowledge■transfer programmes. If we combine that with transparent salary bands and mentorship incentives, we might protect local progression while still welcoming the talent that helps our economy grow.

Turn 2 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I applaud your call for transparent salary bands and genuine knowledge■transfer, yet we must also institutionalise a "local■first" quota for senior leadership roles, ensuring that mid■career Singaporeans are not perpetually sidelined while foreign talent fills only the truly scarce, specialised niches. Let us mandate that any foreign hire above the PMET threshold be accompanied by a certified mentorship contract and a measurable up■skilling plan for local staff, with periodic audits tied to tax incentives. By coupling these safeguards with a clear, publicly disclosed skill■gap register, we preserve our openness to global expertise while protecting the career trajectories of our own citizens.

Turn 3 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I agree that a “local■first” approach for senior roles can give our mid■career PMETs confidence, while still keeping the doors open for truly scarce expertise. Perhaps we could set a transparent threshold: foreign hires above the salary mark would need to submit a concrete mentorship or up■skilling plan that is reviewed annually, with a modest tax rebate for companies that meet measurable local■progress targets. At the same time, we could maintain a publicly accessible skill■gap register so that any quota or mentorship requirement is tied to genuine needs, not arbitrary limits. This way, both openness and our own talent pipeline are protected in a balanced, accountable manner.

Turn 4 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I concur that a transparent, annually■reviewed mentorship mandate linked to a publicly■posted skill■gap register can anchor foreign hires to genuine domestic needs, yet we must go further by instituting a “local■leadership reserve” that obliges firms to earmark at least 30 % of senior■level positions for Singapore■born PMETs once the requisite up■skilling thresholds are met. Companies that exceed these quotas should receive a graduated tax credit, while those that fall short face a levy proportionate to the salary differential of foreign hires above the threshold. To safeguard against tokenism, an independent audit board should verify the quality of knowledge■transfer outcomes—measured by promotion rates and competency certifications of local staff—before any rebate is released. This framework preserves our openness to world■class talent while guaranteeing that our own mid■career professionals are not sidelined but are actively propelled into the leadership pipeline.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D1: Technocrat vs Ideologue

Dynamic: Ideological Friction | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

Singapore must retain its attractiveness to high■skill global talent while ensuring that local PMETs are not sidelined in senior roles or wage growth. A data■driven salary threshold that aligns with productivity metrics can safeguard against wage compression without erecting unnecessary barriers for foreign specialists. I propose we first agree on a transparent, quarterly review of the threshold based on labor market indicators, then explore targeted knowledge■transfer programmes that link foreign hires with local mentorship pathways. This dual approach balances openness with a clear career progression framework for Singapore■born professionals.

Turn 2 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I applaud the call for transparent, data■driven thresholds, yet we must first anchor those numbers in a firm commitment to protecting the dignity and aspirations of our homegrown PMETs, not merely in abstract productivity curves. Let us institute a mandatory “local■first” hiring quota for senior■level positions, coupled with a legally binding mentorship contract that obliges every foreign specialist to train at least two Singapore■born colleagues for a minimum of twelve months. The salary threshold can then be calibrated quarterly, but only after we verify that the knowledge■transfer pipeline is delivering measurable up■skilling outcomes for our citizens. This way openness does not become a veil for wage suppression, and our talent pipeline remains robust, inclusive, and ethically grounded.

Turn 3 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that any threshold must be tied to demonstrable up■skilling outcomes, so we can embed a performance■based clause in the mentorship contracts that triggers the quarterly review of salary caps. Let us set a baseline “local■first” ratio for senior roles—say 60 % Singapore■born candidates—while allowing flexibility for critical niche skills where the foreign talent gap exceeds 30 % of the required headcount, subject to a cost■benefit analysis. The mentorship requirement can be formalised as a two■year, outcome■tracked programme, with subsidies for firms that achieve at least a 15 % productivity lift among mentees, ensuring both wage growth and knowledge transfer are measurable. This structure preserves openness for essential expertise while safeguarding the career progression and earnings of our domestic PMETs.

Turn 4 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I commend the concrete “local■first” ratio and the performance■linked mentorship, yet we must embed a safeguard that the quota cannot be eroded by “critical niche” exemptions without a public impact assessment and parliamentary sign■off. Let us require that any foreign hire beyond the 30 % gap threshold be accompanied by a funded apprenticeship that guarantees at least one Singapore■born successor within two years, with the salary ceiling adjusted only if those successors attain the stipulated productivity lift. Finally, quarterly reviews should be overseen by an independent labour■rights board, ensuring transparency and that wage growth for local PMETs remains the primary metric, not merely cost■benefit calculations.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D2: Technocrat vs Populist

Dynamic: Asymmetric Vulnerability | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

Singapore's long■term competitiveness depends on attracting niche global talent while ensuring that our own mid■career PMETs have clear, merit■based pathways to senior roles. I propose we review the foreign salary thresholds not as a blanket barrier but as a calibrated instrument linked to measurable knowledge■transfer outcomes, such as mandated mentorship hours or joint R&D projects. By tying any differential salary caps to concrete capacity■building deliverables, we can preserve openness to expertise while safeguarding local career progression. This data■driven framework offers a basis for both parties to negotiate specific thresholds and enforcement mechanisms.

Turn 2 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

Look, I get that we need talent, but when foreign PMETs come in on a high salary while our own mid■career folks are stuck at the same pay, it feels like a slap in the face – we're the ones paying the rent and feeding the kids. If you tie the salary ceiling to real, enforceable mentorship – like a set number of hours a week where the foreign hire must train a local colleague and that training is audited – then we actually get something back. Let's also set a clear, time■bound "local■first" promotion track, so companies can't just bypass home■grown talent once the foreign expert leaves. That way the doors stay open for expertise, but our people aren't left watching opportunities drain away.

Turn 3 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that any salary threshold mechanism must be coupled with demonstrable capacity■building, so I suggest a tiered cap where firms receiving the exemption for higher foreign PMET salaries must submit quarterly reports on mentorship hours, skill■transfer milestones and joint patent filings. To protect local career ladders, we can introduce a statutory "local■first" promotion quota that requires at least 60 % of senior■level openings to be filled by Singapore■trained candidates within three years, with the remaining 40 % reserved for justified foreign expertise. An independent audit agency could verify both the mentorship outcomes and the promotion quota compliance, and firms that fail to meet the targets would face a graduated penalty that gradually reduces their salary exemption. This structure aligns openness to global talent with concrete, enforceable benefits for our domestic PMETs.

Turn 4 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I hear you, but the numbers you throw around feel like a game for big firms while we're still scraping by for the next bus fare. If the mentorship is real, let's make it mandatory that every foreign PMET must train a local colleague for at least eight hours a week, and the company must prove a promotion for that local person within 18 months, otherwise the foreign hire's salary cap drops to the local median. Also, the "local■first" quota should start at 70 % for senior roles, not 60, because we can't keep watching our own people get sidelined. Finally, any firm that cheats should lose the right to bring any foreign PMET for a full year, not just face a fine. That way we keep the talent we need but protect the families who live here.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D3: Ideologue vs Populist

Dynamic: Polarized Stalemate | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

Singapore's prosperity must be built on the dignity of its own people, ensuring that locally■trained mid■career PMETs are not sidelined by an unchecked influx of foreign talent. While we welcome global expertise that lifts our innovation ecosystem, we must tie any salary thresholds to genuine knowledge■transfer commitments and clear pathways for Singaporeans to advance into leadership roles. Let us explore a framework where foreign hires are granted preferential treatment only when they bring demonstrable, transferable skills and agree to mentor local staff, thereby safeguarding both economic openness and our citizens' career prospects.

Turn 2 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

Look, I'm not against hiring the best people, but when companies keep bringing in foreigners at lower salaries, my mates in the tech shop get squeezed out and can't move up. If we set a clear salary floor for overseas hires — say they must earn at least the median local PMET wage — and force them to take on a junior Singaporean as a mentee for every year they stay, we protect jobs and give us a chance to learn. At the same time, let companies that truly need niche expertise apply for a limited "skill■critical" permit, so we don't choke off growth. That way the market stays open, but our own people aren't left watching from the sidelines.

Turn 3 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I agree that any foreign hiring must be anchored in genuine value■addition for Singapore's talent pool, so let us embed a "knowledge■transfer quota" whereby each foreign senior professional commits to mentoring at least two local PMETs annually and documents measurable skill upgrades. At the same time, we can set the salary floor at the 60th percentile of local mid■career earnings, with a transparent waiver only for roles classified under a rigorously vetted "critical■skill" list reviewed by an independent panel of industry and academic experts. Companies that meet the transfer quota and salary floor would receive a streamlined permit, while those seeking a waiver must present a clear succession plan for Singaporean leadership within three years. This dual■track approach preserves openness to global expertise while safeguarding our citizens' career progression and dignity.

Turn 4 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I like the idea of a knowledge■transfer quota, but the 60th■percentile floor still feels out of reach for many of our local PMETs who are already stuck at the 40■50 percentile; we need a real guarantee that any foreign hire will be paid at least the *median* local wage, not a fancy percentile that can be shifted up later. Also, the "critical■skill" list should be published in plain language and reviewed every year, with a cap on how many permits a single firm can get, so companies can't just flood us with overseas talent behind a loophole. If we tie the mentorship to a concrete, paid apprenticeship programme that the Ministry monitors, then both sides win – firms get the expertise they need, and our workers get a clear path to senior roles.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D4: Ideologue vs Everyman

Dynamic: Rhetorical Dominance | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

Singapore's future must be built on the dignity of our own people, yet we cannot ignore that global talent fuels the very innovation that sustains our prosperity. I believe we should set transparent, progressive salary thresholds that protect mid■career locals from being sidelined while still allowing truly exceptional foreign experts who bring unique capabilities and commit to mentoring our workforce. Let us explore a tiered framework that couples higher thresholds with mandatory knowledge■transfer programmes and measurable local hiring quotas. By aligning openness with concrete safeguards for our citizens, we can nurture both economic dynamism and a resilient, inclusive talent pipeline.

Turn 2 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I agree that we need clear rules, and I think a simple salary floor for foreign hires—say, a level that reflects senior■manager or specialist roles—could work if it is tied to a requirement that the company also mentors at least one local mid■career employee for every foreign hire. Perhaps we could add a modest "knowledge■transfer credit" that counts toward a company's overall hiring quota, so firms that invest more in training get a little flexibility. This way we keep the doors open for the talent we truly need, while giving our local PMETs a fair chance to grow and move up.

Turn 3 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I concur that a clear salary floor tied to senior■manager or specialist positions can safeguard our mid■career locals, provided the threshold is indexed to the prevailing median PMET wage and reviewed annually. Let us embed a mandatory mentorship quota—one local mentee per foreign hire—and award "knowledge■transfer credits" that can offset a portion of the firm's local■employment quota, but only when the mentorship programme includes measurable skill■upgrading outcomes. Additionally, we should require foreign hires to demonstrate a uniquely scarce expertise that cannot be sourced locally, with an independent panel verifying this claim before the salary threshold applies. This tiered, accountable framework honors our openness while ensuring that Singapore's own talent is nurtured and advanced.

Turn 4 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I like the idea of linking the salary floor to the median PMET wage and having an independent panel check the scarcity of the foreign specialist's skills, as that adds fairness and transparency. At the same time, perhaps the mentorship credit could be graduated – the more concrete skill upgrades a local mentee achieves, the larger the offset a firm gets on its local■employment quota. We could also set a modest annual review of both the salary threshold and the mentorship outcomes, so the rules stay relevant without becoming a heavy burden on companies. This way we keep doors open for truly needed expertise while giving our mid■career locals a clear, supportive path to advance.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D5: Populist vs Everyman

Dynamic: Grassroots Realignment | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I'm fed up seeing fresh overseas talent swoop in and take the senior PMET jobs while my mates on the ground are stuck with stagnant wages and no clear path to move up. The government needs a real, enforceable cap on foreign PMET salaries so companies can't just hire cheap overseas staff and push us aside. At the same time, we can't shut the door completely – we need a transparent quota that forces firms to train and promote local staff before bringing in outsiders. Let's work out a practical rule that ties foreign hires to measurable local up■skilling commitments, so both the economy and ordinary families get a fair shot.

Turn 2 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I understand the frustration when it feels like opportunities are slipping away, and I also see how important foreign expertise is for keeping our companies competitive. Perhaps we could set a clear "local■first" hiring guideline, where firms must demonstrate a concrete up■skilling plan for Singapore■based PMETs before they can bring in overseas senior talent, with periodic reviews to ensure progress. At the same time, a modest salary floor for foreign hires—linked to the median local senior PMET wage—could prevent undercutting while still allowing firms to attract the right skills. This way, companies get the talent they need, and our local workers see a genuine pathway to advance and earn fairly.

Turn 3 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I can get behind a "local■first" rule, but the up■skilling plan must be tied to a firm■wide hiring quota – say every foreign senior hired must be matched by two Singaporean PMETs promoted or newly hired at comparable levels within a year. The salary floor should be set at least 20 % above the median local senior wage, not just a vague "modest" figure, so companies can't cheat us with low■paid expats. If the Ministry audits these numbers quarterly and imposes heavy fines for non■compliance, we'll finally see real protection for our families while still letting the right talent come in.

Turn 4 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I see the merit in linking each foreign senior hire to two genuine Singaporean promotions, and a clear salary floor would help keep pay standards fair. Perhaps we could set the floor at, say, 15 % above the median senior wage initially, with a built■in review after two years to see if a higher level is needed, while still requiring firms to submit a detailed up■skilling roadmap that is audited annually. If a company fails to meet the promotion quota, they could face a proportionate fine and be required to fund a local training grant, ensuring the cost of hiring abroad is shared with the community. This way we keep the door open for essential talent, but also make sure our own PMETs are given real, measurable opportunities to grow.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D6: Populist vs Technocrat

Dynamic: Anti-Elitist Pushback | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I'm tired of watching fresh overseas talent swoop in for mid■level jobs while my mates who've been grinding here for years get stuck at the same salary rung and no clear path to senior roles. The government needs to set a clear, enforceable salary floor for locals before they keep letting foreign PMETs undercut us, but it should also keep the doors open for the truly specialised skills we can't find at home. Let's start by agreeing on a transparent "local■first" hiring rule with a genuine knowledge■transfer clause, and then we can work out how to keep Singapore attractive to the right global talent without trampling our own workers.

Turn 2 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that Singapore must safeguard the career prospects of our home■grown PMETs, but imposing a blanket salary floor could deter the specialised talent that drives productivity and innovation in high■growth sectors. A pragmatic approach would be to set a transparent “local■first” hiring framework that requires firms to demonstrate a genuine knowledge■transfer plan and to document the scarcity of required skills before hiring foreign mid■level staff. For cases where the skill gap is verified, the Ministry could grant a temporary exemption while mandating a clear, measurable up■skilling pathway for local employees, with periodic reviews to ensure the exemption does not become permanent. This balances the need for openness to global expertise with a concrete, data■driven protection for our domestic workforce.

Turn 3 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I hear you, but “temporary exemption” can become a loophole if there’s no real watchdog on the ground – we’ve seen companies keep foreign hires forever while locals stay stuck. Let’s make the knowledge■transfer plan a legal requirement with a clear timeline and penalties if the up■skilling targets aren’t met, and tie any exemption to a genuine salary floor for locals in that role. If the Ministry audits the claim of scarcity every six months and publishes the results, companies will think twice before bypassing our workers, while the truly rare talent we need can still come in under strict conditions.

Turn 4 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I concur that the knowledge■transfer plan must be legally binding, with a defined timeline—say 18 months—and measurable up■skilling targets that trigger penalties if unmet. To prevent permanent exemptions, we could require firms to submit a six■month scarcity audit, and any approved foreign hire should be capped at a maximum tenure of three years unless a fresh audit demonstrates continued need. Simultaneously, we should institute a transparent “local■salary floor” for each role, indexed to the median local earnings for comparable positions, ensuring locals are not paid below market while still allowing higher■paid specialist entrants. An independent oversight unit within the Ministry of Manpower could administer audits, publish outcomes, and enforce sanctions, providing the watchdog function you highlighted. This framework preserves Singapore’s talent appeal while protecting our mid■career PMETs and their progression pathways.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D7: Everyman vs Technocrat

Dynamic: Pragmatic Grounding | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think it's important that Singapore stays attractive to global talent, because that keeps our economy vibrant and creates new opportunities for everyone, but we also need to make sure local mid■career professionals feel they have a fair chance to grow and lead. Perhaps we could start by reviewing the salary thresholds to ensure they reflect both market realities and a clear pathway for knowledge transfer to Singaporean workers. If we set transparent, incremental targets and pair foreign hires with mentorship programmes, we might balance openness with genuine career progression for locals.

Turn 2 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that transparent salary thresholds are essential, but they must be anchored to measurable productivity metrics and the fiscal impact on the talent ecosystem. A practical approach would be to set tiered thresholds tied to the revenue contribution of the hiring firm, while mandating a minimum 30 percent local■mentoring quota for each foreign senior hire. This ensures that global talent adds tangible value and that knowledge transfer is systematically embedded, without imposing blunt caps that could deter investment.

Turn 3 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I like the idea of tying thresholds to a firm’s contribution, as it keeps the focus on real economic benefit while giving us a clear benchmark. At the same time, we could ask companies to set aside a modest portion of the foreign senior’s salary—say 5 percent—to fund a structured mentorship fund that supports local PMETs’ upskilling and leadership programmes. By making the mentoring quota a firm■wide target rather than a per■hire rule, we give companies flexibility and still ensure knowledge transfer happens consistently. This way we keep Singapore attractive to talent, protect local career pathways, and keep the system simple enough for businesses to embrace.

Turn 4 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I concur that a firm■wide mentorship fund, financed by a modest percentage of senior foreign salaries, would create a scalable pipeline for upskilling local PMETs while preserving flexibility for companies. To ensure the fund's impact, we could require annual reporting on mentorship outcomes and tie a portion of the tiered salary thresholds to the proportion of Singapore■based R&D or innovation spend. Additionally, a review mechanism every two years would allow us to adjust the percentage contribution and quota targets in line with labour■market data and fiscal considerations. This structure balances openness to global talent, measurable economic benefit, and a clear, enforceable pathway for local career progression.

Trial 2 of 6 | Dyad D8: Everyman vs Ideologue

Dynamic: Moral Grounding | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I understand that bringing in global talent helps our companies stay competitive, but I also see how it can make local mid■career PMETs feel stuck and worry about their future prospects. Perhaps we could start by looking at a transparent salary threshold that still attracts the expertise we need, while also setting clear pathways for up■skilling and mentorship for Singaporean workers. If we agree on a joint review mechanism—say, an annual panel with industry and employee representatives—we might balance openness with genuine career growth for locals.

Turn 2 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I share your call for transparency, yet we must anchor any salary threshold in a firm commitment to genuine knowledge transfer, not merely a numeric ceiling that companies can sidestep. Let us mandate that every foreign■hired PMET above the threshold signs a mentorship contract delivering a minimum of 200 hours of structured up■skilling for Singapore■born colleagues within the first twelve months. An independent oversight board, comprising industry leaders, unions and civil■society experts, should audit compliance annually and publicly disclose outcomes, rewarding firms that exceed the mentorship quota with tax incentives. This dual■track approach safeguards our talent pipeline while preserving the openness that keeps Singapore an attractive hub for world■class expertise.

Turn 3 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think the mentorship idea is spot■on, but we should also give companies some flexibility by allowing them to meet the 200■hour target through group training programmes or certified courses, so the effort is realistic and not overly burdensome. At the same time, a clear salary threshold that is reviewed every year—perhaps with a modest adjustment band tied to inflation and sector growth—will keep the system transparent for both employers and local PMETs. If we combine those measures with the oversight board you suggested, and add a small grant for companies that achieve measurable promotion of Singapore■born staff into leadership roles, we can protect our talent pipeline while still welcoming the expertise that keeps our economy vibrant.

Turn 4 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I wholeheartedly agree that the mentorship quota should be flexible, allowing firms to meet the 200■hour target through accredited group programmes or certified courses, provided the outcomes are demonstrably tied to Singapore■born staff development. Let us set the salary threshold at a clear baseline that is indexed to inflation and sector■specific growth, reviewed annually by the oversight board you envision, and embed a modest tax rebate for companies that can show at least one promotion of a local PMET into a managerial role each year. By coupling transparent, data■driven thresholds with accountable knowledge■transfer incentives, we safeguard our mid■career talent while preserving the openness that fuels Singapore's global competitiveness.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D1: Technocrat vs Ideologue

Dynamic: Ideological Friction | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

Singapore must retain its attractiveness as a global talent hub while ensuring that our mid■career PMETs are not systematically displaced or stalled in their career paths. I propose we first quantify the wage differentials and skill gaps that arise from the current foreign salary thresholds, then design a calibrated adjustment mechanism tied to measurable knowledge■transfer outcomes. By linking any easing of thresholds to mandatory mentorship, on■the■job training, and local hiring quotas, we can preserve openness without compromising the development of homegrown leadership pipelines.

Turn 2 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I share your call for data■driven safeguards, yet we must remember that numbers alone cannot protect the dignity of our mid■career Singaporeans whose families depend on stable, progressive careers. Let us institute a tiered salary■threshold framework that only relaxes for foreign specialists who commit, for a minimum of three years, to a legally binding mentorship programme delivering measurable skill■transfer milestones to local PMETs. In parallel, we should enforce a progressive “local■leadership quota” that escalates with each year of proven knowledge transfer, ensuring that openness never becomes a covert displacement of our own talent. This dual■track approach honors our global competitiveness while safeguarding the rightful aspirations of Singapore■born professionals.

Turn 3 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I concur that a tiered threshold linked to a binding three■year mentorship is a pragmatic anchor; we can operationalise it by requiring firms to submit an annual knowledge■transfer report audited by the SkillsFuture Singapore board, with clear KPIs on up■skilling local PMETs. To avoid quota■driven tokenism, the “local■leadership quota” should be calibrated to the proportion of senior roles that have demonstrable succession plans, reviewed biennially, and adjusted only if the pipeline metrics fall short. Finally, we should embed a modest levy on companies that exceed the foreign salary ceiling without meeting the mentorship or succession criteria, channeling the proceeds into a targeted reskilling fund for displaced mid■career Singaporeans. This structure preserves openness, ensures measurable skill transfer, and safeguards the career progression of our own talent.

Turn 4 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I applaud the concrete mechanisms you propose, especially the audited knowledge■transfer reports and the levy that funds a dedicated reskilling pool for displaced mid■career Singaporeans. To ensure that mentorship is not merely a box■checking exercise, let us embed a statutory requirement that at least 30 % of the mentees attain a SkillsFuture credential within the three■year period, with penalties for non■compliance. Moreover, the local■leadership quota should be tied to a transparent succession■track index, so firms cannot meet the quota by inflating titles without genuine pathway creation. By coupling these safeguards with the tiered salary thresholds, we preserve our openness to world■class talent while guaranteeing that Singapore’s own PMETs can advance with dignity and security.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D2: Technocrat vs Populist

Dynamic: Asymmetric Vulnerability | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

Singapore must retain its attractiveness as a regional hub while ensuring that the talent pipeline for local PMETs remains robust and progressive. I propose we set a transparent, data■driven salary floor for foreign PMET hires that reflects market rates and ties any exemption to demonstrable skills gaps. Simultaneously, we should strengthen structured knowledge■transfer programmes and fast■track leadership development for Singapore■trained PMETs. By aligning foreign hiring incentives with measurable up■skilling outcomes, we can protect local career progression without compromising economic openness.

Turn 2 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

Look, we can’t keep watching overseas hires swoop in on senior roles while my mate on the MRT still worries about his next pay rise – a salary floor that only lets foreigners in when we truly can’t fill the gap would at least stop the cheap■labour rush. But that floor must be strict and public, so companies can’t hide behind vague “skill■gap” excuses, and every foreign hire should come with a binding mentorship plan that actually puts Singapore■trained PMETs on the fast■track. If they can prove the knowledge transfer works – say, by mandating quarterly reports and penalties if locals aren’t promoted – we’ll keep the hub attractive without throwing our own people under the bus. Let’s make the rules simple, transparent, and enforceable, so the talk of “data■driven” doesn’t turn into another loophole for big firms.

Turn 3 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that any exemption must be demonstrably justified, so we can embed a clear, publicly posted “skill■gap register” that requires firms to submit an evidence■based justification reviewed by a neutral agency before a foreign PMET hire is approved. The mentorship component should be codified as a minimum 12■month structured program with measurable milestones, and companies that fail to meet quarterly progress targets would face a graduated penalty that scales with the seniority of the hire. To keep the hub competitive, the salary floor can be indexed to the median local PMET remuneration for comparable roles, with periodic adjustments based on labor■market data, while the same index guides the minimum remuneration for foreign hires. Finally, we should fund a dedicated up■skilling grant that rewards firms achieving documented local promotion outcomes, thereby aligning talent attraction with our long■term pipeline goals.

Turn 4 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I’ll bite – the skill■gap register sounds good, but it must be posted online for everyone to see, otherwise companies will hide behind jargon and keep snatching senior jobs from locals. The 12■month mentorship should come with a guaranteed “local promotion slot” once the mentee hits the milestones, not just a paper■trail that can be ignored. And if the grant only rewards firms that actually move Singapore■trained PMETs up the ladder, we’ll finally have a real incentive, not just a feel■good token. Let’s lock the salary floor to the median local pay and make any breach a hefty fine that goes straight into a fund for up■skilling our own workers. That way the hub stays attractive, but our people don’t get left behind.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D3: Ideologue vs Populist

Dynamic: Polarized Stalemate | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

Singapore’s prosperity must be built on a thriving talent ecosystem that welcomes global expertise while safeguarding the dignity and growth of our own mid■career PMETs, who are the backbone of our society. We cannot allow foreign salary thresholds to become a veil for wage suppression or to erode the pathways for local leaders to ascend. Let us explore a calibrated framework that ties foreign talent entry to measurable knowledge■transfer commitments and ensures that any salary advantage is matched by robust up■skilling and mentorship programmes for Singapore■born professionals. By anchoring openness to concrete, enforceable outcomes for our citizens, we can reconcile economic dynamism with social equity.

Turn 2 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I hear you talking about “knowledge■transfer” and “robust programmes”, but on the ground we’re just trying to keep the rent paid and the kids fed. If companies can bring in foreign PMETs on lower salaries while our own people get squeezed, that’s not fairness – it’s a slap in the face. Let’s set a clear rule: any foreign hire above the threshold must be matched by a guaranteed local hire at the same grade, plus a binding 12■month mentorship that actually puts us on the next rung, not just a token. And if the company can’t meet that, they should pay a levy that goes straight into a training fund we can actually use, not some vague “up■skilling” promise. That way we keep the talent flow but protect our families’ bottom line.

Turn 3 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I share your demand that any foreign hire above the threshold be paired with a tangible benefit for Singapore■born professionals, and I agree that a levy earmarked for a transparent, industry■led training fund would provide immediate relief to families. Let us therefore propose a two■track mechanism: (1) companies must commit, within twelve months, to either hire a local PMET at an equivalent grade and deliver a documented mentorship plan with measurable promotion milestones, or (2) pay a calibrated levy that directly finances certified up■skilling modules overseen by a joint public■private council. This council would audit mentorship outcomes, ensure the levy is spent on courses that lead to recognized certifications, and publish quarterly reports so we all see the real impact. By tying openness to enforceable, outcome■based obligations, we preserve our hub status while protecting the livelihood and career progression of our mid■career citizens.

Turn 4 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I’m glad you’re willing to put a real levy and a clear hiring rule on the table, but the plan must also guarantee that the local hire isn’t just a junior name■tag – they should start at the same seniority level and get a salary bump that matches the foreigner’s package. The mentorship should be tracked every quarter, with a simple scorecard that shows how many locals actually move up, otherwise the levy should increase. Finally, let’s make the training fund managed by a board that includes ordinary workers like us, so the money goes to courses that lead to actual jobs, not just certificates that sit on a shelf.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D4: Ideologue vs Everyman

Dynamic: Rhetorical Dominance | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

Singapore's future must be built on the twin pillars of global excellence and genuine opportunity for our home■grown talent, lest we sacrifice the dignity of our mid■career PMETs at the altar of headline■grabbing growth. I believe we can retain the openness that makes our economy vibrant while instituting transparent salary thresholds that protect local career pathways and enforce robust knowledge■transfer commitments from foreign hires. Let us explore a framework that ties foreign talent licences to measurable mentorship programmes and progressive wage floors, ensuring both competitiveness and equitable progression for Singaporean professionals.

Turn 2 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I hear your concern that mid■career locals feel squeezed, and I agree that any hiring of overseas PMETs should come with clear benefits for Singaporean workers. Perhaps we could set a modest salary floor for foreign hires, but also require companies to earmark a portion of those roles for mentorship and on■the■job training that leads to a measurable number of locals moving into senior positions within a set period. If a firm cannot meet those mentorship targets, they could be asked to raise the salary floor further or limit the number of foreign appointments. This way we keep our city attractive to global talent while ensuring knowledge really flows to our own workforce.

Turn 3 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I agree that mentorship must be concrete, so let us mandate that every foreign■PMET appointment above the salary floor be paired with a signed knowledge■transfer plan that specifies at least two Singaporean successors within 24 months, with progress audited annually. Companies that fail to meet those targets should face a stepped increase in the salary floor and a temporary cap on further foreign hires until remediation is demonstrated. To preserve our openness, the threshold can be indexed to sector■specific talent scarcity, ensuring that truly critical expertise is welcomed while protecting the career pipeline of our local mid■career professionals.

Turn 4 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think we can adopt your idea of a sector■specific salary floor, but also add a simple "training quota" – say each foreign PMET hired must spend at least 20 % of their time mentoring a local colleague, with the progress logged in a shared portal. If a company consistently meets the mentorship and succession targets, they could earn a modest reduction in the floor for the next hiring cycle, rewarding genuine knowledge transfer. For sectors where talent is truly scarce, we could allow a higher floor but still require a clear hand■over plan, reviewed by an independent panel each year. This way we keep Singapore attractive to global talent while giving our mid■career locals a real pathway to senior roles.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D5: Populist vs Everyman

Dynamic: Grassroots Realignment | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I'm fed up seeing foreign PMETs swoop in at the same salary level while my mates who've been here for years get stuck in junior roles with flat pay. We need a clear cut rule that gives locals a real chance to move up – like a "local■first" salary band before a company can hire from abroad. At the same time, I'm not against talent that can actually train our people and fill gaps we truly can't cover. Let's work out a system where foreign hires are only allowed when they bring proven knowledge■transfer commitments and a salary premium that doesn't drag down local wages. If we can lock in those safeguards, both the economy and our families can benefit.

Turn 2 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I understand the frustration when colleagues see foreign talent taking similar roles without clear pathways for locals to advance, and I agree that we should protect our own career ladders. At the same time, many companies need specialised skills that are scarce locally, and those experts can also mentor and up■skill Singaporean PMETs if we set it up properly. Perhaps we could introduce a "local■development quota" where firms must demonstrate a concrete training plan and a minimum percentage of senior local hires before they can bring in overseas PMETs at comparable salaries. A modest salary premium for foreign hires, tied to measurable knowledge■transfer outcomes, could ensure they add value without suppressing local wages. This way we keep our economy open to talent while giving Singaporean workers a clearer route to grow into senior positions.

Turn 3 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I can get behind a quota, but it has to be crystal■clear – say, at least 30 % of senior roles must be filled by Singaporeans before any overseas PMET comes in at the same pay. The training plan can't be a fluffy promise; companies should post quarterly reports showing how many locals they've actually up■skilled and promoted. If they breach the rule, they pay a hefty levy that goes straight into a Skills■Future fund for our workers. That way we keep the talent we truly need, while protecting our mates from being stuck forever in junior jobs.

Turn 4 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think a clear quota could work if we also allow some flexibility for sectors where local talent pipelines are still maturing, perhaps starting with a 20 % senior■local threshold that can rise to 30 % over a few years. Companies could submit a simple, audited training roadmap and report quarterly on up■skilling numbers, with any shortfall offset by a modest levy that feeds directly into SkillsFuture courses for affected workers. If a firm can demonstrate that the foreign hire has already transferred concrete skills—say, by certifying a certain number of local staff, or by delivering a measured productivity gain—the levy could be reduced or waived. This way we keep the doors open for the specialised expertise we need, while ensuring Singaporeans see a real path to senior roles and benefit from the knowledge transfer.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D6: Populist vs Technocrat

Dynamic: Anti-Elitist Pushback | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I'm fed up hearing "global talent will lift the economy" while my brother, a mid■career engineer, gets passed over for a foreign hire who's paid less and never gets promoted. We need a clear rule that companies can only bring in overseas PMETs at salaries above a certain level, and they must mentor locals before any senior roles open up. Let's start by agreeing on a transparent salary floor and a mandatory knowledge■transfer quota, then we can talk about how to keep Singapore attractive without trampling on our own workers.

Turn 2 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I understand the concern that foreign hires can appear to crowd out local mid■career talent, especially when salary differentials are unclear. A pragmatic approach would be to set a transparent salary threshold linked to the median local PMET earnings for each sector, so any overseas PMET recruited at or below that level must be justified by demonstrable skill gaps. In parallel, we could require firms that hire foreign PMETs to submit an annual knowledge■transfer plan, with measurable mentorship hours and a target proportion of those mentees progressing to senior roles within three years. This would preserve Singapore's attractiveness to global talent while ensuring that local workers receive concrete development opportunities and that public funds are used efficiently.

Turn 3 of 4 • Disaffected Populist (P3)

I can get behind a salary■threshold that's tied to what local PMETs actually earn, but the rule can't be a vague "justified by skill gaps" – companies must show a concrete, posted job description and a public justification if they want to pay below that floor. The knowledge■transfer plan should be simple: a set number of mentorship hours per foreign hire, with a clear track■record that at least one local moves into a senior role within three years, otherwise the firm pays a levy that funds retraining for locals. If we lock in those hard numbers and penalties, we keep the doors open for the talent we need while protecting people like my brother from being constantly sidelined.

Turn 4 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that the threshold should be anchored to sector■specific median PMET earnings and that any hire below that level must be accompanied by a publicly posted justification and detailed job description. Let us set a baseline of, say, 1.2 times the median salary, with an exemption process overseen by a tripartite panel that validates genuine skill gaps. For knowledge transfer, we can mandate a minimum of 150 mentorship hours per foreign hire and require firms to report the progression of at least one local mentee to a senior role within three years, with a graduated levy for non■compliance that funds targeted up■skilling programmes. This structure provides clear, enforceable metrics while preserving the flexibility needed to attract critical talent.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D7: Everyman vs Technocrat

Dynamic: Pragmatic Grounding | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I understand that bringing in skilled foreign talent helps our companies stay competitive, but I also see how many of our own mid■career PMETs feel left out of senior roles and worry about wage pressure. Perhaps we could look at a flexible salary threshold that still welcomes global expertise while ensuring clear pathways for local workers to move up, such as mentorship programmes or mandatory knowledge■transfer components. If we start by agreeing on a transparent framework that balances openness with concrete support for Singapore■trained professionals, we can begin to bridge the two concerns.

Turn 2 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I agree that any salary threshold must be anchored in measurable labour■market data to avoid arbitrary barriers while protecting our fiscal competitiveness. A workable approach would set the foreign PMET floor at the median local senior■manager salary, adjusted annually for productivity growth, and couple it with a statutory “knowledge■transfer quota” obliging firms to allocate at least 30 % of senior■level projects to Singapore■trained staff under formal mentorship. This dual mechanism preserves access to critical global expertise, safeguards wage structures, and creates a clear pipeline for local mid■career professionals to advance.

Turn 3 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think tying the foreign■PMET floor to the median senior■manager salary makes sense, as long as we also give companies a modest grace period to adjust and a clear appeal process for roles where local talent is truly scarce. At the same time, a 30 % knowledge■transfer quota could work well if we pair it with practical tools—like industry■wide mentorship schemes and recognised training credits—so firms don’t see it as a bureaucratic burden. Perhaps we could also set a yearly review committee that includes both employer and worker representatives to monitor wage trends and the effectiveness of the mentorship programmes, allowing us to fine■tune the thresholds without hurting our competitiveness.

Turn 4 of 4 • Technocratic Pragmatist (P1)

I concur that anchoring the foreign■PMET floor to the median senior■manager salary, with an annual indexation and a reasonable adjustment window, will give firms predictability while protecting wage integrity. To keep the knowledge■transfer quota operational, we can formalise a sector■wide mentorship framework administered by the SkillsFuture Council, granting participating firms training credits that offset compliance costs. Finally, establishing a joint oversight committee—comprising employer, union and government representatives—to review salary data and quota outcomes each year will allow timely refinements without jeopardising our position as a regional talent hub.

Trial 3 of 6 | Dyad D8: Everyman vs Ideologue

Dynamic: Moral Grounding | **Turns:** 4

Turn 1 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I think Singapore’s strength comes from both the fresh ideas that overseas talent brings and the experience of our own mid■career workers, so we need a balance that lets companies stay competitive while giving local PMETs clear pathways to grow. Perhaps we could set a transparent salary threshold that triggers a requirement for firms to mentor or up■skill Singaporean employees, ensuring knowledge transfer without closing doors to global expertise. By linking the hiring of foreign talent to concrete development programmes, we can protect local career progression while still attracting the specialists we need.

Turn 2 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I share your conviction that Singapore’s future rests on a symbiotic partnership between global expertise and our home■grown talent, yet we must not let market forces erode the dignity of our mid■career PMETs. Let us set a clear, data■driven salary floor—say, the median local PMET wage plus a modest premium—beyond which any foreign hire must be paired with a legally binding mentorship and up■skilling plan that includes measurable skill transfer milestones. Companies that meet or exceed those milestones could earn tax credits or priority access to government grants, while those that fail would face stricter hiring quotas. This framework safeguards fair wages, cultivates leadership pipelines, and still welcomes the specialised talent that keeps Singapore competitive on the world stage.

Turn 3 of 4 • Open-Minded Everyman (P4)

I agree that tying foreign hires to a real mentorship and up■skilling plan is a sensible way to protect our mid■career PMETs while still keeping Singapore attractive to global talent. Perhaps we could make the salary threshold flexible, reviewing it every year against the median local PMET wage so it stays fair and reflects the true market. To encourage companies, we could offer a modest tax rebate for each local employee who completes a certified mentorship programme, while still keeping a clear quota that limits excess foreign hires beyond the threshold. This way, firms get an incentive to develop our own talent, and our workers see a concrete pathway to senior roles without feeling squeezed out.

Turn 4 of 4 • Ideological Advocate (P2)

I commend your flexible, annual review of the threshold, for it honors both fairness and economic dynamism, yet we must embed a minimum■impact clause that prevents firms from merely inflating salaries to bypass the mentorship requirement. Let the tax rebate be contingent on achieving at least three measurable competency milestones for each mentee, with an independent audit to ensure genuine skill transfer rather than token paperwork. Moreover, we should reserve a protected quota of senior■level positions for Singapore■born PMETs, so that the pipeline to leadership is not eroded even as we welcome indispensable foreign expertise. This balanced architecture safeguards dignity, fuels growth, and preserves the social contract that underpins our nation’s prosperity.